

KIKYUUGAOKA
PRIVATE ACADEMY

INTERNAL REVIEW BOARD

CONFIDENTIAL

CLASSIFIED
EYES ONLY



02: THE IMMUNE RESPONSE

In a system built
on control,
immunity
is rebellion.



EPISODE TWO

THEY TOLD US THE SYSTEM WAS PROTECTING US.
THEY WERE WRONG.

THE MORNING AFTER.

KUROHANE PREFECTURAL
HIGH SCHOOL MAIN COURTYARD.

私たちの信頼を、取り戻すために。

—黒羽県立高校生徒会

HIDEO NAKA.
STUDENT COUNCIL
TREASURER.
AGE 18.

...AND WE'RE
LIVE ON THE
SCENE AT KUROHANE
PREFECTURAL HIGH
SCHOOL, WHERE
STUDENT COUNCIL
TREASURER HIDEO
NAKA IS BEING
ESCORTED BY POLICE
LIAISON OFFICERS
THIS MORNING...

KUROHANE
PREFECTURAL HIGH SCHOOL
黒羽県立高等学校

HIS FACE SAYS
EVERYTHING.

HIS SILENCE
SAYS THE REST.

HE WAS THE
ONE
EVERONE
TRUSTED.

THE ONE
WHO HANDLED
THE MONEY.

THE ONE
WHO HAD
ACCESS.

NAKA! LOOK
AT WHAT YOU'VE
DONE! LOOK AT
WHAT YOU'VE
DONE!

DID YOU SEE
THE EMAIL?

YEAH... IT'S
EVERYTHING.

WHO SENT
THIS?

NO IDEA...

THE TRUTH
THE SCHOOL
DOESN'T WANT
YOU TO KNOW.

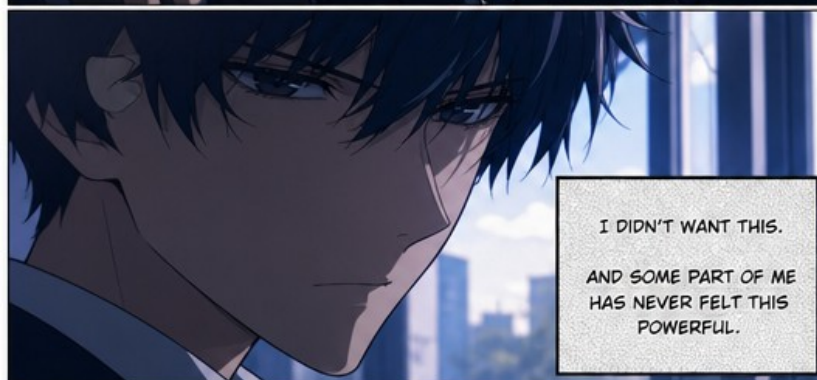
Attachments (1)
Student_Council_Records.zip
2.4 MB

DUDE...

THIS IS
INSANE.

TRUTH HAS CONSEQUENCES.

Part 2



MID-MORNING.
THE FACULTY OFFICE.
PHONES RINGING.
ANSWERS: NONE.

FACULTY
OFFICE

Vice
Principal
Ashida...

Mr. Tanaka,
notify the parents.
Stick to the facts.
No promises.

VICE PRINCIPAL
ASHIDA

FIFTIES. IMPECCABLE.
THE HUMAN FACE OF
INSTITUTIONAL
ACCOMMODATION.

Ms. Kuroda,
prepare the incident
report. Use the
standard language.
No speculation.

TODAY'S SCHEDULE
1. Staff Meeting
2. Discipline Committee
3. Parent Calls
4. Reports

CONFIDENTIAL

DISCIPLINE
REVIEW
IN PROGRESS

Yes, this is Ashida.
...
Yes, I understand
your concerns.

Rest assured,
we are taking
appropriate
action.

We have
procedures
for situations
like this.

No, of course
we won't discuss
any details with
the students.

Thank you for
your cooperation.

Calm.
Meticulous.
Never Panicked.

He doesn't
manage people.

He manages
outcomes.

The phones
keep ringing.

The system
keeps moving.

That's the point.

Everyone
thinks he's
on our side.

Maybe he is.

But his first
loyalty...

...is to the
institution.

ASHIDA IS NOT THE PROBLEM.
HE IS THE SOLUTION THE SYSTEM
CREATED FOR ITSELF.

ACCOMMODATED.
NOT EVIL.
EXACTLY AS
IT MUST BE.



HINOMIYA PRIVATE ACADEMY
STUDENT COUNCIL ROOM

WE APOLOGIZE
FOR THE DISRUPTION,
PRESIDENT TENDO.

THE LAST
OF THE LEDGERS.

THE PAST,
BOXED AND
REMOVED.

SHE SAYS
NOTHING.

OFFERS NO
OBJECTION.

POLITE.
INSTITUTIONAL.
PATIENT.

EXACTLY
ONE DEGREE.
THE FIRST
CRACK.

THE ROOM
IS HALF-EMPTY.

THE ORDER
IS BROKEN.

CLICK.

ERASURE
WEARS A
FAMILIAR FACE.

INHERITED
GUILT.
PRIVATE
SUSPICION.

1

THE
PAST
DOESN'T
SPEAK.

IT
REMEMBERS
THROUGH
THOSE
WHO
STILL
TOUCH.



REIKA TENDO
18

READER OF THE PAST

PRESIDENT, TENSHO
STUDENT COUNCIL

2



3



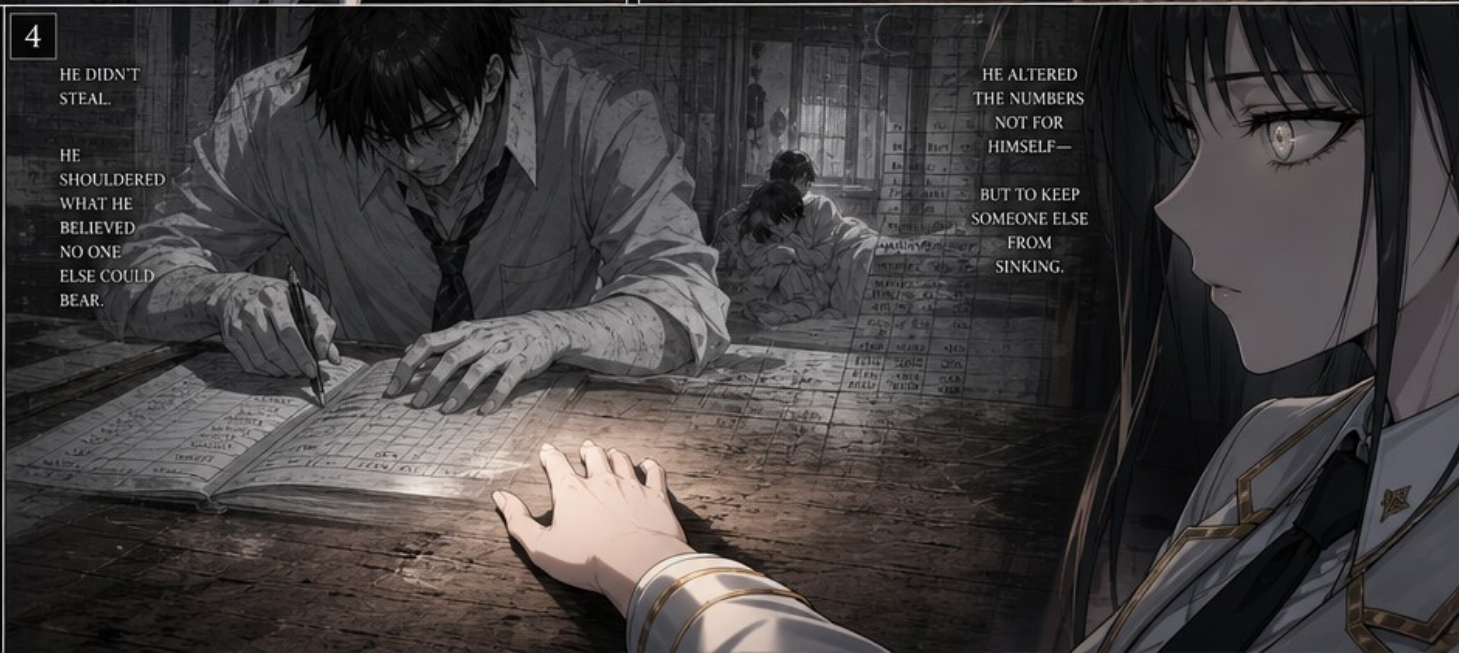
4

HE DIDN'T
STEAL.

HE
SHOULDERED
WHAT HE
BELIEVED
NO ONE
ELSE COULD
BEAR.

SOME
LEDGERS
CARRY
DEBT.

SOME
CARRY
LOVE.



HE ALTERED
THE NUMBERS
NOT FOR
HIMSELF—

BUT TO KEEP
SOMEONE ELSE
FROM
SINKING.



STUDENT COUNCIL ROOM.
CONTINUOUS.

REIKA TENDO.
18.
THE READER
OF THE PAST.

BARE HAND
STILL ON NAKA'S DESK,
SHE RECEIVES
A SECOND, FAINTER
LAYER WITHIN
THE SAME PAST-VISION.

A MORE RECENT TRACE.
BLUE-TINGED RATHER
THAN PURELY MONOCHROME.

OF SOMEONE ELSE
PRESENT IN THIS ROOM
VERY RECENTLY.

STANDING NEAR THIS
EXACT DESK WITH THE
SPECIFIC COLD-PRECISE
STILLNESS OF A PERSON
READING RATHER THAN
TOUCHING.

THE FIGURE IS INDISTINCT—
A SHAPE, A SCHOOL UNIFORM,
A QUALITY OF STILLNESS
SHE HAS FELT ONCE BEFORE,
IN A HALLWAY, WITHOUT
KNOWING WHAT SHE
WAS FEELING.

SHE PUTS HER
GLOVE BACK ON.

FINGER BY
FINGER.

THE RITUAL
REVERSED WITH
METICULOUS
PRECISION.

THE MONOCHROME
VISION DISSOLVES.

BLUE-TINGED TRACE
FRAGMENTS SCATTERED
LIKE MEMORY.

PIECES ASSEMBLE.

THE LEAK'S
IMPOSSIBLE
SPECIFICITY.

THE TRACE OF
SOMEONE READING
THE ROOM'S TRUTH
WITHOUT NEEDING
TO TOUCH
ANYTHING.

A BOY SHE HAS
NOTICED BEFORE
WITHOUT
UNDERSTANDING
WHY.

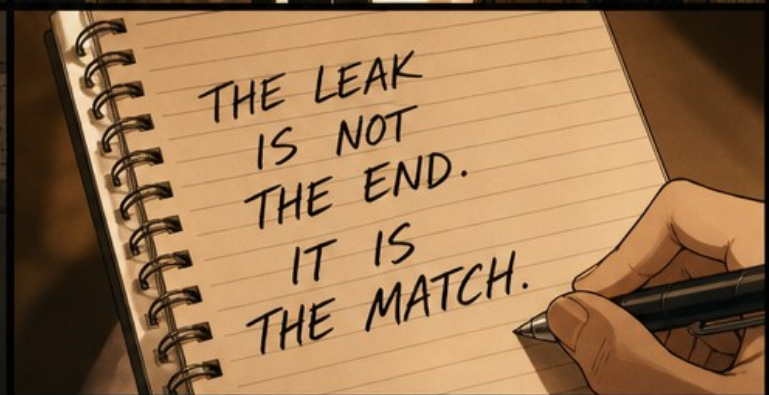
The leak didn't
just expose
a crime.

It destroyed
a kindness.

AS HER EXPRESSION
HARDENS INTO
RESOLUTE FOCUS—

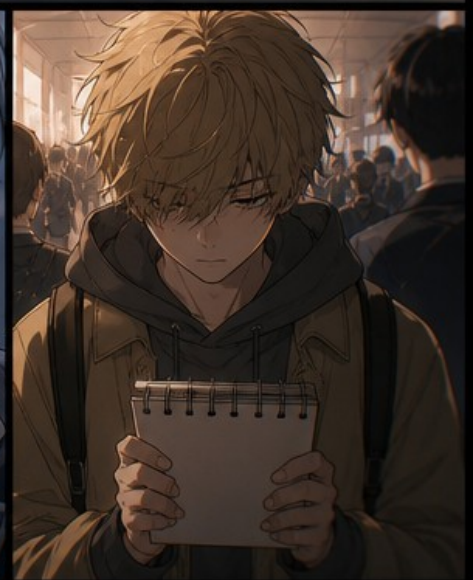
THE CLOSING
PUNCTUATION OF
COMPOSURE
RESTORED OVER
NEW PURPOSE.







He's the epicenter.



THE ROOFTOP.

NEUTRAL GROUND.
NO WITNESSES.
ONLY TRUTH.

SUMMONED
BY A NOTE
LEFT IN
HIS SHOE
LOCKER.

TENDO REIKA

READER OF THE PAST
STUDENT COUNCIL PRESIDENT



KAI MORI

READER OF TRUTH



SHE CLEANS
WHAT OTHERS
IGNORE.

DUST.
RUST.
HISTORY.

たし
/SWISH

HE PACES
IN PATTERNS.

THREE STEPS.
AND A TURN.

THREE STEPS.
AND A TURN.

1... 2... 3.

TURN.

1... 2... 3.

TURN.

SHE DOES
NOT LOOK
AT HIM.

YET BOTH
KNOW—

THIS ROOFTOP
BELONGS TO
THEM BOTH.

HE DOES
NOT LOOK
AT HER.

TWO READERS.
ONE TRUTH.

NO LIES LEFT
TO HIDE BEHIND.



YOU
DID THIS.



PULLING THREADS
IN THIS SCHOOL
UNRAVELS THINGS
FAR DARKER THAN
EMBEZZLEMENT.

AND SOME OF
THOSE THREADS
RUN BACK TO A PLACE
THE CURRENT
ADMINISTRATION
WOULD VERY MUCH
LIKE FORGOTTEN.



...



THE
OLD WING.



What the school
forgets,
someone always
remembers.





ASHIDA'S
SECURITY IS COMING
UP TO CLEAR THE ROOF
NOW!

SORA MINABE, 16
THE READER OF THE FUTURE
SIGNATURE: WARM AMBER

KAI MORI, 17
THE READER OF MEMORY
SIGNATURE: NAVY-COLD BLUE

REIKA TENDO, 17
THE READER OF ABSOLUTE ORDER
SIGNATURE: WHITE-GOLD



I DON'T KNOW THEM.
THEY DON'T KNOW ME.
BUT RIGHT NOW...
WE'RE ALL THAT STANDS
BETWEEN THE FUTURE
AND BEING ERASED.



ANALYZE.
ADAPT.
ACT BEFORE
THEY DO.



ORDER ISN'T GIVEN.
IT'S MAINTAINED.
NO MATTER
THE VARIABLES.



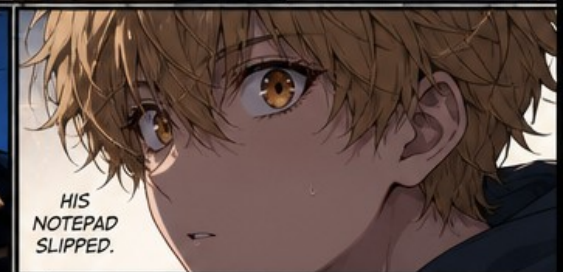
FOOTSTEPS.
ON THE STAIRS
BELOW.



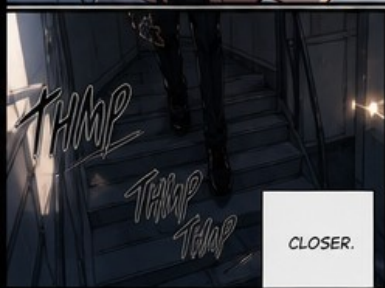
MY
BREATH
CAUGHT.



HIS EYES
WIDENED
FRACTIONALLY.



HIS
NOTEPAD
SLIPPED.



CLOSER.



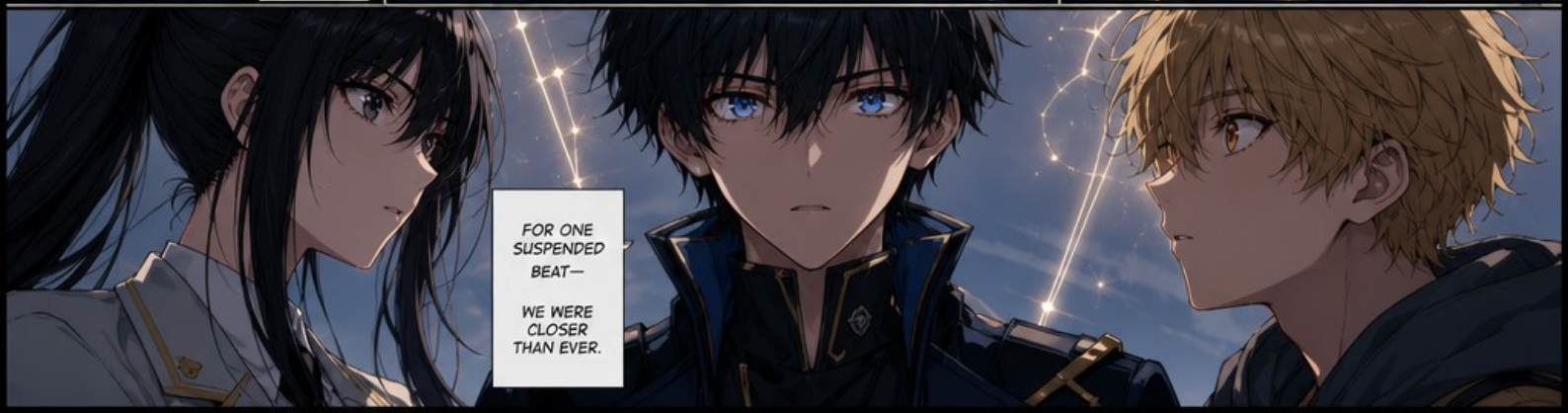
NONE OF US
UNDERSTOOD.

ALL OF US
FELT IT.



THE FIRST
SIGNAL.

THE FIRST
RECOGNITION.



FOR ONE
SUSPENDED
BEAT—

WE WERE
CLOSER
THAN EVER.

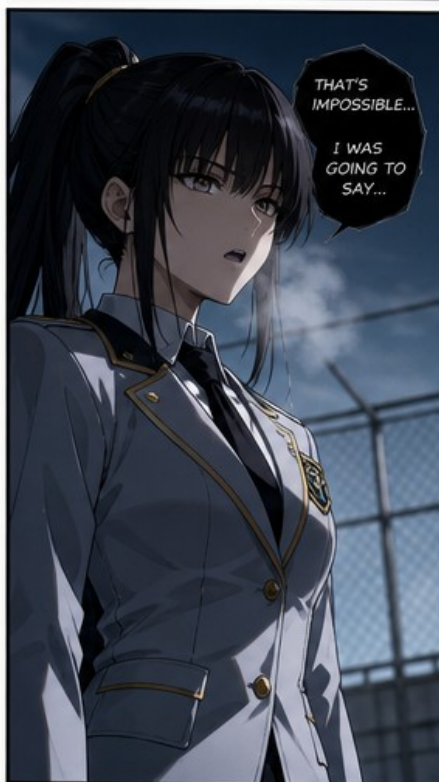


CHAPTER 37
THE VISIBLE ABSENCE
PART 1
THE FIRST MANIFESTATION

VELETH CUT

THE INTERRUPTION

A SOURCELESS COLD.
NO SOURCE.
NO SHADOW.
ONLY ABSENCE.



THAT'S
IMPOSSIBLE...

I WAS
GOING TO
SAY...



THE DATA
DOESN'T
SUPPORT...

I WAS
ABOUT TO
EXPLAIN...



YOU
SHOULDN'T
BE HERE...

I WAS
GOING TO
TELL YOU...



THE AIR
BETRAYS ITSELF.
THREE BREATHS.
ONE SILENCE.

VELETH
HAS ARRIVED.

VELETH CUT
THE INTERRUPTION



¥570

EPISODE 2
CLOSING.



3F
NEW WING



2F
NEW WING



1F
OLD WING



B1
BASEMENT



B2
DEEP BASEMENT
BELOW OLD WING



*The Machinery of the school was never the real enemy.
The Cold is awake.*